```
@using WebApplication1                                    ❶
@using WebApplication1.Pages                              ❶
@using WebApplication1.Models                             ❷
@addTagHelper *, Microsoft.AspNetCore.Mvc.TagHelpers      ❸
```

❶ The default namespace of your application and the Pages folder

❷ Adds this directive to avoid placing it in every view

❸ Makes Tag Helpers available in your views, added by default

The _ViewImports.cshtml file can be placed in any folder, and it will apply to all views and subfolders in that folder. Typically, it's placed in the root Pages folder so that it applies to every Razor Page and partial view in your app.

It's important to note that you should only put Razor directives in _ViewImports .cshtml; you can't put any old C# in there. As you can see in the previous listing, this is limited to things like `@using` or the `@addTagHelper` directive that you'll learn about in chapter 18. If you want to run some arbitrary C# at the start of every view in your application, such as to set the `Layout` property, you should use the _ViewStart.cshtml file instead.

Running code for every view with _ViewStart

You can easily run common code at the start of every Razor Page by adding a _ViewStart.cshtml file to the Pages folder in your application. This file can contain any Razor code, but it's typically used to set the `Layout` for all the pages in your application, as shown in the following listing. Then you can omit the `Layout` statement from all pages that use the default layout. If a view needs to use a nondefault layout, you can override it by setting the value in the Razor Page itself.

Listing 17.15 A typical _ViewStart.cshtml file setting the default layout